

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 562

By Campbell

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Abigail Goddard, founder of Spikey, for her dedication to promoting public safety in Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those outstanding young Tennesseans whose innovation, initiative, and dedication to community safety bring honor to our State; and

WHEREAS, one such remarkable individual is Abigail Goddard, a seventeen-year-old senior at Ravenwood High School in Williamson County, whose pioneering work in drink-spiking detection technology has gained national attention and is transforming safety efforts across Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, moved to action at the age of fifteen after learning that a close family member had suffered a drug-facilitated sexual assault during her freshman year of college, Ms. Goddard recognized the urgent need for discreet, youth-friendly, and reliable tools to help prevent such crimes, which occur in the United States every sixty-eight seconds, with an estimated seventy-five percent of victims being drugged or intoxicated at the time of assault; and

WHEREAS, Abigail Goddard partnered with pharmaceutical experts to design Spikey, an innovative, keychain-style testing device that allows users to apply a drop of their drink onto a concealed strip; within fifteen seconds, the strip may change color if the beverage contains a common date-rape drug such as GHB, ketamine, scopolamine, cocaine, or other amine-based substances; and

WHEREAS, Spikey is customizable with names, initials, or Greek letters, making it both pragmatic and appealing to students, young adults, and nightlife patrons; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Goddard's work has been supported by the Williamson County Entrepreneurship and Innovation Center, where she refined her pitch and secured early funding; she began selling Spikey directly to peers and has since distributed more than 14,000 test strips and generated more than \$30,000 in revenue; and

WHEREAS, demonstrating both entrepreneurial excellence and civic responsibility, Abigail Goddard has competed in nine business competitions, winning or placing in all of them, and has won over \$40,000 to reinvest in her expanding company; her next phase of development includes transitioning Spikey's production from 3D printing to professional injection molding to increase scale and durability; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Goddard is already strengthening Tennessee's community safety efforts through partnerships with organizations such as Nashville's Safe Bar program, which recently ordered approximately 3,000 Spikey devices for distribution; and

WHEREAS, Abigail Goddard is further engaged with State and federal lawmakers, including U.S. Senator Marsha Blackburn, to promote emerging legislation related to drink safety, reflecting her commitment to ensuring that preventative tools become widely accessible throughout college campuses, Greek-life organizations, nightlife venues, and major events; and

WHEREAS, national, regional, and local media have recognized Ms. Goddard's exceptional leadership, vision, and advocacy on behalf of student and community safety; and

WHEREAS, Abigail Goddard exemplifies the very best of Tennessee's youth through her ingenuity, perseverance, and devotion to improving the lives of others, and she should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Abigail Goddard, founder of Spikey, for her extraordinary achievements in entrepreneurship, public safety innovation, and

community leadership, and extend to her our best wishes for continued success in all her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.